Rachel Berwald

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EDUCATION

University of California, Los Angeles
Ph.D., Political Science — Expected 2027
Committee: Cesi Cruz (co-chair), Graeme Blair (co-chair), Stuart Soroka, Michelle Torres, and Natália Bueno — 2024
M.A., Political Science — 2019

Tulane University, New Orleans, Louisiana
B.A. Political Science–International Relations (Honors)

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Political identity, Brazil, social media and WhatsApp, institutional trust, comparative political communication, misinformation

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Berwald, Rachel. (Forthcoming). "The Power of Pre-existing Beliefs: How Misinformation and Vote Choice Influenced Public Trust in Brazil's 2022 Presidential Election." *Revista Latinoamericana de Opinión Pública.*

WORKING PAPERS

Partisan Learning: Receptiveness to Pedagogy-Informed Media Literacy Lessons in Brazil

The Salience of Political Identity in Brazil

Correcting Misinformation, but Sustaining Conclusions: The Role of Emotional and Partisan Attachments in Narrative Persistence (with Seonhye Noh)

PUBLIC-FACING SCHOLARSHIP

"Spotting Misinformation about LA Wildfires." (with Cesi Cruz). January 2025.

"Interventions to Counter Polarization: Lessons from the Global North and Applications to

the Global South". (with Joshua Goetz, Dan Harker, Connor Warshauer, Sabrina Habchi, AP Turek, and Nikita Savin). *Evidence for Governance and Politics* (Berkeley, CA) September 2023.

"Cross–Party Program Approaches: An evidence review". (with Paige Rumelt, Anoushka Chandarana, and Mariz Younan). *IRI* (Washington, D.C.) August 2022.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

APSA Annual Conference	2026
Population Association of America Annual Conference (P) -with Sinem Esengen & Emily Kaner	2026
APSA Political Communication Pre-conference	2025
Southern California Political Behavior Conference	2025
Communications Horizons at UC Davis	2024
Brazilian Studies Association Annual Conference (C)	2024
WAPOR, Asia-Pacific Conference	2023
EGAP Democracy, Conflict, & Polarization Meeting	2023
APSA Annual Conference	2023
APSA Short Course on Public Opinion, Social Media, Misinformation, and Elections	2023
MPSA Annual Conference	2023
Tulane University Honors Thesis Forum	2019
Latin American and Latinx Studies Symposium at Rollins College	2019
Tulane University Student Conference on Latin America	2018

[Paper presentation unless noted otherwise: C = chair, D = discussant, P = poster]

GRANTS AND AWARDS

Dissertation Year Award, UCLA ($30,000)	2026
Enhanced Collaboration Grant Award, UCLA ($20,000) –with Cesi Cruz, Saadia Gabriel, & Nikita Savin	2026
Political Psychology Fellowship for Non-dissertation Work, UCLA ($1,000) –with Seonhye Noh	2025
International Institute Fieldwork Grant, UCLA ($900)	2025
Bedari Kindness Institute Research Fellowship, UCLA ($18,450)	2025
Latin American Institute Summer Research Grant, UCLA ($2,000)	2024
Initiative for the Study of Hate Research Innovation Fund, UCLA ($99,855) –with Cesi Cruz, Daniel Triesman, Nikita Savin, José Gloria, & Dan Harker	2023
Political Psychology Fellowship for Conference Travel, UCLA ($273)	2023
Graduate Research Mentorship, UCLA ($32,024)	2023
Foreign Language Area Studies Fellowship, UCLA ($8,500)	2023
Graduate Summer Research Mentorship, UCLA ($6,000)	2022
Segal AmeriCorps Education Award, AmeriCorps ($12,190)	2021
Newcomb College Institute Grant, Tulane University ($490)	2019
Fulbright English Teaching Assistant Brazil: Semifinalist	2019

TEACHING

Instructor of Record, University of California, Los Angeles:
World Politics (Summer Institute), Summer 2025

Teaching Fellow, University of California, Los Angeles:
Introduction to Comparative Politics, Fall 2025

Teaching Assistant, University of California, Los Angeles:
Introduction to Comparative Politics, Spring 2025
Political Violence, Winter 2025
World Politics, Winter 2023, Spring 2023, Fall 2024
Introduction to Programming and Data Management, Fall 2022

TRAINING

Summer Institute in Computational Social Science (UCLA)	2025
Summer School in International Survey Methods (Vanderbilt University)	2024

SELECTED ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

Grad Maven (for Writing, Math, and R)	2026-2027
Research Advocate, FORCE	Since 2025
Department Office Assistant	2022–2024
Research Assistant, Professor Cesi Cruz	Since 2022
Special Education Teacher, Teach KIPP Believe Primary School Teach for America, New Orleans, Louisiana	2019–2021

International Research Experience:

- CET Study Abroad, São Paulo, Brazil 2023
- IFSA Butler, Buenos Aires, Argentina 2017
- Mandel-Palagye Program for Middle East Peace, Jerusalem, Israel 2017

SERVICE

Departmental Service:
Mentor to first-year students 2022–2025

Reviewer: *International Journal of Public Opinion Research; Journal of Elections, Public Opinion and Parties*

AFFILIATIONS

Political Communication and Behavior Lab
California Center for Population Research
Learning, Identities, Networks, and Communities Lab
Brazilian Studies Association
American Political Science Association
Midwest Political Science Association

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (advanced), Spanish (advanced)
Statistical Analysis: R, LaTeX
Teaching Tools: Canvas